



Movement Community Guidelines

In order to participate in this space, we agree to abide by the following community guidelines¹.

- A. This is a brave space.** We are here to provide a space for participants to come together to educate and support each other about justice in both science and the world, and work to create change in our community. We agree not to perpetuate harmful oppressive behavior knowingly.
- B. Risk, Reflect, Repair.** In order to learn and be in right relation, we must be willing to RISK potentially harming others with our language, actions, and behavior. Otherwise, we create false relationships on shaky ground. We understand that harming each other is inevitable, and that when we do we may be called to reflect on what we did or said. Once we have understood the harm, we can focus on repairing trust and changing our behavior moving forward.
- C. What happens here, stays here.** We agree not to share the personal narratives and opinions of others without first obtaining explicit permission, especially online. This allows us to share useful information while respecting an individual's right to privacy. We can, however, share general lessons learned during discussions.
- D. Awareness of power dynamics.** In many group settings, members of privileged groups and those already with power often dominate the discussion. While we cannot eradicate power differentials, we agree to be cognizant of the power dynamics at play and strive to reduce them as much as possible.
- E. Sharing the air.** If we find ourselves taking up a lot of room, we agree to take a step back and let others participate. If we find ourselves trying to take up as little space as possible, we will challenge ourselves to participate more.

¹ These guidelines are adapted and expanded from the Code of Conduct at the first Inclusive Astronomy Meeting in 2015



Movement Community Guidelines

- F. Being raggedy.** As Kyla Wazana Tompkins says, we aren't here to learn what we already know. Society rewards us for being perfect and having all the answers, but this is an impediment to our growth. We agree to show up exactly as we are, ask the questions that come into our heads, and admit when we just don't know.
- G. Leaning into discomfort.** Discussions about injustice often require us to examine issues that we do not want to talk about - especially as it pertains to our inner selves. However, the most progress is often made by leaning into our own discomfort so that we are able to address what needs to be addressed.
- H. Respecting pronouns.** We agree to use the correct pronouns when addressing our fellow participants. If we do not know someone's pronouns, we agree to ask.
- I. Yes and.** We are here to build each other up and honor each other's stories, experiences, and ideas. Rather than asserting that someone is wrong, or that their idea would never work, we agree to accept that multiple truths can exist at one time.
- J. Impact > Intent.** We all enter into this space with good intentions. However, sometimes we end up saying or doing something that is harmful. Good intentions do not excuse harmful behavior, so we agree to acknowledge when we have harmed someone and take the necessary steps to repair - regardless of our intentions.
- K. Speaking to our own experience.** Using "I" or "we" statements helps with avoiding generalizations. We agree to speak for ourselves, and to be full of care when explaining or commenting on others' experiences.
- L. Embracing curiosity.** It can be tempting to respond to others' stories with our comments or opinions - especially if their experience contradicts our own and we are feeling defensive. We agree to ask questions to learn more about our fellow participants rather than



Movement Community Guidelines

impose our truths on them.

M. Awareness of intersectionality. A common practice in society is to focus on a single dimension of identity. This approach leaves behind, for example, women of color who are impacted by the intersection of racism and sexism. We agree to recognize that each person has a unique matrix of identities and experiences. We will not assume that members of marginalized groups share an identical set of experiences.

N. Oops/Ouch/Umm. When someone in the group inevitably says something hurtful or problematic, we can say “ouch” to flag the comment. The person who made the harmful comment can say “oops” to acknowledge the harm, apologize, and then try again. If someone says something that feels harmful but we’re not quite sure how, we can say “umm” to let the person know their comment might need to be unpacked.